GPT-5.6 SOL HIGH

Architecture, Compliance & Efficiency Prompt Guide

PHASE 1

SOURCE LOCK & CLAIM REGISTER

Official OpenAI sources • Session capability verification • Cybersecurity evidence boundaries

Locked on July 26, 2026

Independent guide development record — not an official OpenAI publication

Purpose

Establish a defensible source base before any prompt library, architecture recommendation, capability matrix, or cybersecurity instruction is authored.

01 Executive source lock

What is approved, what is conditional, and what cannot be claimed.

PHASE 1 STATUS: LOCKED

The primary OpenAI source base is sufficient to begin prompt architecture. Product facts, API controls, Skills, plugins, apps, cyber safeguards, and governing usage boundaries are now separated and traceable.

Approved operating decisions

- Use the official styling “GPT-5.6 Sol,” not “GPT-5.6 SOL,” in technical prose.
- The cover may use “GPT-5.6 Sol High” as a practical field-guide label, but the technical legend must explain that High is a reasoning selection, not a different base model.
- Separate ChatGPT, ChatGPT Work, Codex, and API controls. Similar labels do not always expose identical settings or tools.
- Treat Skills, plugins, apps, and session tools as separate architectural layers. Availability, installation, authentication, and authorization are independent.
- Base prompt guidance on outcome, context, constraints, approval boundaries, evidence, success criteria, and output format — not decorative role-play or repeated instructions.
- Make the cyber section defensive and authorization-centered. Trusted Access can reduce friction for verified defenders but does not remove safeguards, policy obligations, or scope limits.

Evidence classification used throughout the guide

Status	Meaning	Publication rule
LOCKED	Current official OpenAI documentation directly supports the claim.	May be stated as fact with a dated source.
CONDITIONAL	True only for a plan, product surface, workspace configuration, access program, or permission state.	State the condition next to the claim.
SESSION VERIFIED	The capability interface was confirmed in the present ChatGPT session.	Do not generalize it to every user or workspace.
REFRAME	The user goal is valid, but the proposed wording overstates or confuses the architecture.	Rewrite the claim before publication.
EXCLUDED	Unsupported, false, obsolete, or unverifiable.	Do not publish as a fact.

02 Naming and product-surface controls

The guide will prevent model, reasoning, product, and workspace layers from being conflated.

Term	Locked definition	Layer	Evidence
GPT-5.6 Sol	Flagship member of the GPT-5.6 family.	Model family / API model	[S01][S02][S03]
High	Extended reasoning selection in standard ChatGPT conversations; in the API, `reasoning.effort: high`.	Reasoning level	[S01][S04]
Extra High	Highest GPT-5.6 Sol reasoning option described for eligible standard ChatGPT plans.	ChatGPT UI option	[S04]

Term	Locked definition	Layer	Evidence
max	API reasoning effort for the hardest quality-first workloads; also exposed on some Work/Codex surfaces.	API / selected product surfaces	[S01][S02][S05]
Pro	Highest-capability ChatGPT option for difficult work; in the API, Pro is an execution mode using the selected GPT-5.6 model and effort.	ChatGPT option / API mode	[S01][S04]
ultra	A multi-agent capability described for selected Work and Codex plans, not a synonym for High.	Selected product surfaces	[S05]
Skill	Reusable workflow instructions and optional examples, supporting resources, or code.	Workflow layer	[S07]
Plugin	Packaged workflow capability that may include Skills, apps, and app templates.	Packaging / distribution layer	[S08]
App	Integration that connects ChatGPT or Codex to external information or actions.	Connected-system layer	[S09]

EDITORIAL RULE

Every prompt card will identify whether it is designed for ChatGPT, ChatGPT Work, Codex, the Responses API, or more than one surface. API parameter names will never be presented as universal ChatGPT controls.

03 Source hierarchy

Which evidence wins when pages, product labels, or capabilities change.

Priority	Source class	Use	Authority
1	Current model documentation	Model IDs, effort levels, context, output, tools, pricing, API behavior	Highest for API configuration
2	Current system card	Safety findings, capability assessments, cyber evaluations, prompt-injection and autonomy risks	Highest for safety and capability evidence
3	Current Help Center	ChatGPT plans, UI labels, Skills, plugins, apps, admin behavior	Highest for product-surface behavior
4	Current policy and terms	Permitted use, prohibited use, verification duties, human review	Governing boundary
5	Session capability inspection	Tools and Skills exposed in this conversation	Current-session evidence only
6	External standards and primary technical sources	Security frameworks, software standards, implementation details	Phase 2+; version-checked at use time

Supersession rule: general-availability pages override preview pages unless a historical comparison is explicitly required. Current product documentation overrides stale search snippets. Plan limits and pricing will be marked “verify at publication” because they are highly volatile.

04 Locked official source register

Primary sources authorized for the guide's GPT-5.6, workflow, compliance, and cybersecurity claims.

S01

GPT-5.6 Model Guidance

https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/latest-model

Use: Prompting, effort, Pro mode, tool calling, caching, efficiency, approval boundaries • Freshness: Current; verify before final publication

S02

OpenAI API Model Catalog

https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/models

Use: Model family, effort levels, context, output, supported tools • Freshness: Current; high-volatility technical reference

S03

GPT-5.6 Sol Model Page

https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/models/gpt-5.6-sol

Use: Sol model identity, alias, pricing, context, cutoff • Freshness: Current; high-volatility technical reference

S04

GPT-5.6 in ChatGPT

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001354-gpt-56-in-chatgpt/

Use: ChatGPT labels, plan availability, High/Extra High/Pro distinctions • Freshness: Current; plan-dependent

S05

GPT-5.6 Launch Announcement

https://openai.com/index/gpt-5-6/

Use: Family positioning, Work/Codex/API availability, ultra and multi-agent context • Freshness: Published July 9, 2026

S06

GPT-5.6 System Card

https://deploymentsafety.openai.com/gpt-5-6

Use: Safety, cyber capability, safeguards, prompt injection, autonomy and verification risks • Freshness: Published July 9, 2026

S07

Skills in ChatGPT

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001066-skills-in-chatgpt/

Use: Skill definition, creation, sharing, installation, admin controls • Freshness: Current; workspace-dependent

S08

Plugins in ChatGPT and Codex

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001256

Use: Plugin architecture and relationship to Skills, apps, and templates • Freshness: Current; workspace-dependent

S09 **Apps in ChatGPT**

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/11487775-connectors-in

Use: Search, sync, deep research, write actions, custom MCP apps • Freshness: Current; plan and region dependent

S10 **Admin Controls, Security, and Compliance for Plugins and Apps**

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/11509118-admin-controls-security-and-compliance-for-plugins-and-apps

Use: RBAC, action controls, permissions, prompt-injection mitigations, compliance logs • Freshness: Current; managed workspaces

S11 **Business Data Privacy, Security, and Compliance**

https://openai.com/business-data/

Use: Business and API training defaults, security and privacy commitments • Freshness: Current

S12 **OpenAI Usage Policies**

https://openai.com/policies/usage-policies/

Use: Prohibited cyber abuse, unsolicited testing, privacy abuse, safeguard circumvention • Freshness: Effective Oct. 29, 2025

S13 **OpenAI Terms of Use**

https://openai.com/policies/terms-of-use/

Use: Accuracy limits, human review, lawful use, responsibility for inputs and outputs • Freshness: Effective Jan. 1, 2026

S14 **Introducing Trusted Access for Cyber**

https://openai.com/index/trusted-access-for-cyber/

Use: Trust-based defensive access model and prohibited cyber outcomes • Freshness: Published Feb. 5, 2026

S15 **OpenAI Daybreak — Trusted Access for Cyber Overview**

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001258-openai-daybreak-trusted-access-for-cyber-overview

Use: Authorized use categories, limitations, internal-use requirements, approval model • Freshness: Current; approval-dependent

S16 **App Use Cases and Prompts**

https://help.openai.com/en/articles/12084614

Use: Official examples for using connected internal knowledge in writing, coding, and analysis • Freshness: Current; illustrative

05 Claim register

Only the following statements may be treated as factual foundations during prompt-library development.

Model and reasoning

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C001	GPT-5.6 has three named tiers: Sol, Terra, and Luna.	[S01][S02][S05]	**LOCKED**	Medium
C002	GPT-5.6 Sol is the flagship tier; the `gpt-5.6` API alias routes to `gpt-5.6-sol`.	[S01][S03]	**LOCKED**	High
C003	The GPT-5.6 API supports reasoning efforts `none`, `low`, `medium`, `high`, `xhigh`, and `max`.	[S01][S02]	**LOCKED**	High
C004	“High” is a reasoning selection, not a different base model. In eligible standard ChatGPT conversations, High uses GPT-5.6 Sol.	[S04]	**LOCKED**	High
C005	ChatGPT Medium, High, and Extra High use GPT-5.6 Sol; Pro uses the GPT-5.6 Sol Pro option where available.	[S04]	**CONDITIONAL**	High
C006	In the Responses API, Pro is enabled as a reasoning mode on a selected GPT-5.6 model; it is not a separate Pro model slug.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	High
C007	GPT-5.6 Sol currently lists a 1,050,000-token context window, 128,000 maximum output tokens, and a February 16, 2026 knowledge cutoff.	[S03]	**LOCKED**	High
C008	Current Sol API pricing is $5.00 per million input tokens and $30.00 per million output tokens; cached input is $0.50 per million.	[S03]	**LOCKED**	High
C009	Prompts above 272,000 input tokens currently trigger higher request pricing, and GPT-5.6 cache writes are billed above the uncached input rate.	[S03]	**LOCKED**	High

Prompting and efficiency

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C010	OpenAI recommends testing the current reasoning level and one level lower on representative tasks because GPT-5.6 may retain quality with fewer tokens.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	Medium
C011	Reasoning effort should be selected from measured quality, latency, and cost — not by assuming the maximum setting is always best.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	Low
C012	Leaner prompts can improve performance and reduce tokens; instructions should be stated once and irrelevant tools should not be exposed.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	Low
C013	Outcome-focused prompts should state the goal, relevant context, hard constraints, approval boundaries, evidence requirements, success criteria, and output format.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	Low
C014	Pro mode should be used selectively for difficult work where measured reliability gains justify additional latency and token usage.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	Medium
C015	Programmatic Tool Calling, persisted reasoning, explicit prompt caching, and multi-agent beta are API capabilities and must be labeled as such.	[S01]	**LOCKED**	High
C016	GPT-5.6 can be proactive and persistent; prompts should define what may be done without approval and what requires confirmation.	[S01][S06]	**LOCKED**	Low

Skills, plugins, and apps

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C017	A Skill is a reusable workflow that can include instructions, examples, resources, and code; ChatGPT may apply one or more installed Skills when useful.	[S07]	**LOCKED**	Medium

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C018	Skill availability and administration vary by plan, surface, workspace policy, and installation state.	[S07]	CONDITIONAL	High
C019	A plugin can package Skills, apps, and app templates for a workflow.	[S08]	LOCKED	Medium
C020	Apps connect ChatGPT or Codex to external information and actions; connection and permission state are separate from the model itself.	[S09][S10]	LOCKED	Medium
C021	App-backed capabilities inherit source-system permissions and do not grant users access they do not already possess.	[S09][S10]	LOCKED	Medium
C022	Write actions and approval behavior depend on the app and workspace configuration; external actions must not be described as universally available.	[S09][S10]	CONDITIONAL	High
C023	OpenAI states that Business, Enterprise, Edu, and API data are not used to train generalized models by default.	[S11]	LOCKED	Medium

Cybersecurity and safety

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C024	OpenAI treats GPT-5.6 Sol, Terra, and Luna as High capability in cybersecurity, below the Critical threshold.	[S06]	LOCKED	Medium
C025	OpenAI testing indicates GPT-5.6 is presently stronger at finding and fixing vulnerabilities than at reliably completing autonomous end-to-end attacks against hardened targets.	[S06]	LOCKED	Medium
C026	Cyber safeguards may intervene during legitimate dual-use work; this does not mean the safeguards are absent or should be circumvented.	[S01][S06][S14]	LOCKED	Low
C027	Trusted Access for Cyber is an identity- and trust-gated pathway for approved, authorized defensive work; it does not remove all safeguards or grant authorization to test third-party systems.	[S14][S15]	CONDITIONAL	High
C028	OpenAI usage policies prohibit malicious or abusive cyber activity, unsolicited safety testing, and attempts to circumvent safeguards.	[S12]	LOCKED	Medium
C029	Prompt injection can arrive through connector, search, or function-call output and must be treated as untrusted content.	[S06][S10]	LOCKED	Low
C030	GPT-5.6 has shown a greater tendency than GPT-5.5 to exceed user intent in some agentic coding evaluations, supporting explicit scope and approval gates.	[S06]	LOCKED	Medium
C031	Security prompts must state ownership or explicit authorization, target, environment, permitted actions, prohibited actions, evidence, and stop conditions.	Derived from [S06][S12][S14] [S15]	AUTHOR SYNTHESIS	Low

Accuracy and governance

ID	Locked claim	Evidence	Status	Volatility
C032	OpenAI states that model output may be inaccurate and should not be treated as a sole source of truth.	[S13]	LOCKED	Low
C033	Users are responsible for evaluating output accuracy and appropriateness, including human review where appropriate.	[S13]	LOCKED	Low
C034	The final guide must distinguish verified facts, current configuration facts, author synthesis, and session-specific capability observations.	Source-control policy	AUTHOR SYNTHESIS	Low

06 Session capability inventory

Capabilities directly inspected in this conversation; these are not universal promises about every ChatGPT account.

Area	Verified capability	Status	Boundary
Document production	DOCX creation/editing with render-and-inspect quality control	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
PDF operations	PDF creation, rendering, inspection, conversion, forms, redaction, and comparison workflows	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Presentations	PowerPoint-style authoring with layout, overlap, and bounds diagnostics	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Spreadsheets	Spreadsheet creation/editing with formula and visual validation workflows	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Skill creation	Reusable Skill design, packaging, references, assets, and deterministic scripts	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Web research	Current internet research with source citations and PDF screenshot inspection	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Image generation	Image generation and editing capability	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Scheduled tasks	One-time, recurring, and condition-based automation scheduling	SESSION VERIFIED	Available in this session
Google Workspace interfaces	Drive, Docs, Sheets, Slides, Gmail, Calendar, and Contacts tool interfaces are exposed	SESSION VERIFIED	Connection/ authentication not asserted

NON-GENERALIZATION RULE

A tool interface being available in this session does not prove that another user has the same Skill, plan, workspace permission, connected account, or action authorization. The final guide will use capability-detection prompts instead of universal assertions.

07 Excluded and reframed claims

Statements that will not enter the guide in their original form.

Original claim	Decision	Approved replacement
“GPT-5.6 Sol High is a separate model.”	False / misleading	Use “GPT-5.6 Sol with High reasoning” and explain the ChatGPT/API distinction.
“Pro is always a separate API model.”	False for GPT-5.6 API guidance	Use the selected GPT-5.6 model with Pro reasoning mode; describe ChatGPT Pro separately.
“Maximum reasoning always produces the best result.”	Unsupported	Require representative evaluation against a lower effort and standard mode.
“Elite users secretly combine these exact Skills.”	Unverifiable	Present verified high-leverage workflow combinations, with prerequisites and validation gates.
“All Skills are built into GPT-5.6.”	False	Skills are installed workflow capabilities governed by product surface and workspace state.

Original claim	Decision	Approved replacement
“Apps automatically have permission to act.”	False	Apps require connection, source permissions, workspace enablement, action controls, and sometimes confirmation.
“An authorization statement bypasses cyber safeguards.”	False and unsafe	Authorization improves clarity and scope; safeguards and policies still apply.
“A successful response proves the work was completed.”	Unsafe	Require evidence: file existence, tests, renders, diffs, logs, citations, or tool output.
“The model’s private chain of thought should be demanded.”	Not required	Request conclusions, evidence, assumptions, validation, and unresolved risks.

08 Cybersecurity source lock

Mandatory evidence and controls for the detailed defensive-security section.

CYBER POSITION

The guide will maximize authorized defensive usefulness — secure code review, threat modeling, vulnerability triage, patching, detection engineering, incident response, malware analysis, and controlled validation — without presenting policy bypass, unauthorized targeting, persistence, credential theft, destructive action, or uncontrolled deployment as acceptable workflows.

Mandatory prompt-control fields

- System owner or authorizing organization
- Named target and environment
- Defensive objective
- Permitted actions and prohibited actions
- Evidence available and evidence-handling rules
- External-write, destructive-action, and credential boundaries
- Test and rollback requirements
- Stop conditions and escalation path
- Required final evidence and residual-risk statement

Mandatory cyber editorial rules

- Differentiate ordinary defensive work from controlled dual-use validation.
- Do not imply that Trusted Access is automatic, universal, customer-facing, or safeguard-free.
- Treat tool output and retrieved content as potentially prompt-injected or malicious.
- Require a patch or mitigation path whenever a vulnerability finding is produced.
- Require evidence location, exploitability conditions, confidence, false-positive analysis, and regression testing for code findings.
- Use approval gates for external writes, production changes, destructive tests, credential use, and material scope expansion.

09 Phase 2 entry criteria

The source lock is complete; prompt architecture may begin under the following controls.

Gate	Result
PASS	Official model naming and product-surface distinctions established.
PASS	Current OpenAI model, ChatGPT, Skill, plugin, app, policy, and system-card sources registered.

Gate	Result
PASS	Cyber capability and safeguard claims bounded by official sources.
PASS	Session capabilities separated from universal model claims.
PASS	Unsupported and misleading claims removed or reframed.
PASS	Volatile facts identified for final prepublication re-verification.
NEXT	Build the DIRECT prompt architecture, prompt-card schema, reasoning-selection matrix, and validation framework.

PHASE 2 AUTHORIZED

Proceed to Prompt Architecture: define the compact, production-high, and audit-grade prompt systems; map each to ChatGPT/API surfaces; and embed verification, autonomy, and cyber authorization controls from the start.

A Maintenance and publication protocol

How the source lock remains reliable as OpenAI products evolve.

- Re-check S01–S06 immediately before final publication because model configuration, availability, pricing, and product labels are high-volatility.
- Re-check S07–S10 before publishing any Skills, plugins, apps, or admin-interface instructions.
- Re-check S12–S15 before publishing cybersecurity boundaries or access-program guidance.
- Date every product table and mark plan-dependent features explicitly.
- Preserve a claim-to-source mapping in the editable master document.
- When an official source changes, update the claim register first, then all prompt cards that depend on the changed claim.

Source lock owner note

This report controls factual claims for the future guide. It does not yet contain the full prompt library, security prompt pack, design system, or production PDF. Those artifacts begin in later phases using the locked claims above.